

Ricky Circelli

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EDUCATION

University of South Carolina

Columbia, SC

Bachelor of Science; Major: Finance (Darla Moore School of Business)

Aug. 2024 – May 2028

Second Major: Data Science (College of Arts & Sciences); GPA: 4.0

- **Honors and Involvement:** President's List (4x), NCAA CSC Academic All-District Team, SEC Academic Honor Roll, South Carolina Honors College
- **Relevant Coursework:** Statistical Methods I & II, Applied Statistics, Computing for Data Science, Data Analytics, Algorithmic Design I, Corporate Financial Analysis
- **Certification:** IBM Data Science Professional Certificate; Microsoft Power BI Data Analyst (PL-300); Claude Certified Architect (CCA-F)

INTERCOLLEGIATE ATHLETICS

University of South Carolina Men's Track & Field

Columbia, SC

Student-Athlete

Aug. 2024 – Present

- Balance a 4.0 GPA while competing as an NCAA Division I student-athlete, training approximately 25 hours per week as a middle-distance runner (800m, 1500m)

EXPERIENCE

Ally Financial

Charlotte, NC

Quantitative Modeling Intern

May 2026 – August 2026

- Developed an end-to-end machine learning credit risk model for auto lending across 200,000+ loan applications and 2,000+ variables, owning the full pipeline from raw data through model evaluation
- Modeled both booked and unbooked application populations, applying reject inference to correct selection bias and improve out-of-sample predictive accuracy
- Reduced a 2,000+ variable set to its most predictive drivers via feature engineering, Information Value (IV) analysis, and correlation reduction, lowering model complexity without sacrificing accuracy
- Trained and evaluated XGBoost, LightGBM, CatBoost, and Random Forest models in Python and Snowflake, validating performance with AUC, KS, log loss, calibration, and SHAP explainability
- Automated loan application decisioning with the model, approving 4x more loans automatically at lower risk while cutting manual review from 80% to 20% of applications

Varsity Stack

Columbia, SC

Founder

February 2026 – Present

- Founded an AI-powered athlete supplement intelligence platform, leading product, engineering, and go-to-market
- Shipped full-stack mobile and web products to production solo, using Claude Code, LLM APIs, and AI-assisted workflows to cut build timelines from months to weeks
- Integrated wearable and health data with large language models to deliver personalized supplement recommendations
- Named Top 5 Finalist in the SEC Startup Competition while growing past 1,000+ downloads, onboarding 2 teams, and converting paying users into recurring subscription revenue

PROJECTS

AI Portfolio Optimizer - Independent Project

May 2025 – July 2025

- Built an AI-powered robo-advisor using Python, Plaid APIs, and Monte Carlo simulation to generate personalized ETF portfolios based on investor risk profiles
- Automated portfolio recommendations by building ML pipelines that combined alternative financial data and generative AI, removing manual allocation decisions

LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

Gamecock Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning

Active Member

November 2024 – Present

- Build and train machine learning models in a student team and apply them to place in applied AI competitions

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Programming:** Python, SQL, R
- **Machine Learning:** XGBoost, LightGBM, CatBoost, Random Forest, scikit-learn, TensorFlow, SHAP
- **Generative AI:** OpenAI API, Claude API, Prompt Engineering, AI Agents, Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG)
- **Developer Tools:** Claude Code, Codex, Git, GitHub, VS Code, Jupyter
- **Data:** Snowflake, Pandas, NumPy, Feature Engineering, ETL Pipelines
- **Analytics:** Credit Risk Modeling, Predictive Modeling, Information Value (IV), Reject Inference, Calibration, Monte Carlo Simulation, Statistical Analysis
- **Cloud & Platforms:** AWS, Supabase, Railway, Power BI, Excel